



POTOMAC DATABASE SYSTEMS ADVANCES LOW-COST DATA INFRASTRUCTURE FOR THE LUNAR ECONOMY

McLean, VA, May 18, 2026 — Potomac Database Systems (Potomac) announced a product roadmap to build the data layer for the lunar economy, beginning with low-cost lunar reconnaissance systems and advancing toward persistent surface intelligence infrastructure. These systems are designed to establish and characterize landing sites through high-fidelity, long-duration reconnaissance and monitoring, with initial deployments targeted as early as 2028. As a result, Potomac will reduce by orders of magnitude the cost of accessing critical lunar data, supporting the transition from one-off missions to sustained lunar operations.

“The lunar economy will not scale if every dataset requires a dedicated mission,” said Jacob Matthews, CEO and Founder of Potomac. “We will make lunar data accessible on demand, removing the cost and complexity that have historically limited the market.”

With soft lunar delivery often costing on the order of \$1 million per kilogram, dedicated landing missions make many lunar datasets prohibitively expensive. Potomac’s early products reduce reliance on dedicated soft landings by using impact-plume reconnaissance and impact-emplaced surface nodes. Compass, Potomac’s LCROSS-inspired impact-plume reconnaissance product, is designed to characterize material signatures from impact-generated lunar ejecta. Pathfinder, a ballistic surface node, is designed to survive high-velocity emplacement and return localized ground-truth data from targeted lunar sites. Together, these products provide lower-cost ways to characterize lunar sites before customers commit to larger persistent deployments.

Source extends this roadmap into persistent lunar operations. Designed to survive the lunar night using radioisotope heater units (RHUs), Source will use a rover to collect high-fidelity surface data over long durations, reducing data costs by spreading landing and deployment costs across a larger volume of commercially useful datasets. Built to operate in extreme cold and darkness, including potentially in permanently shadowed regions, Source will support landing site selection, resource prospecting, and mission planning.

To support Source’s future deployment, Potomac announced the release of a Request for Information (RFI) for commercial providers of RHUs. By integrating RHUs into Source’s system architecture, Potomac aims to address lunar night survival, one of the key technology gaps facing sustained lunar operations.

“As NASA advances the Commercial Lunar Payload Services initiative to target a near-monthly lander cadence by 2027, the limiting factor will not just be access to the Moon. It will be access to reliable surface intelligence,” said Matthews. “Potomac is the scout to ensure that a Moon Base and Fission Surface Power (FSP) have the information they need to be successful.”

Responses to the RFI are requested by 5:00 p.m. ET on June 5, 2026.

ABOUT POTOMAC DATABASE SYSTEMS

Potomac Database Systems is building commercial data infrastructure to make lunar access affordable for government, commercial, and academic customers. Potomac's products include Compass, a low-cost impact-plume reconnaissance system; Pathfinder, an impact-emplaced surface node; Source, a RHU-enabled mobile sensor suite; and Nexus, a web-based lunar data visualization and analysis platform.

For more information, visit <https://potomacdb.com/>.

Media Contact

Jackie Toth
Owner, New Hill Consulting
jackie@newhillconsulting.com